

4th

The 4th Sheet

Your accountant gives you three sheets. I give you the fourth.

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Sample Electrical & Air Pty Ltd

An electrical and air-conditioning contractor in Brisbane: maintenance contracts, installations and call-outs. 7 technicians, 3 office staff.

How final is this data?

September 2026	Locked	September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.
August 2026	Locked	August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.
October 2026	Incomplete	October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

The fourth sheet: September 2026 vs August 2026

Gross margin (P&L), September

34.4%

▼ from 35.5% in Aug

Cost to win a customer

\$162

▼ from \$205 in Aug

Technician time on jobs

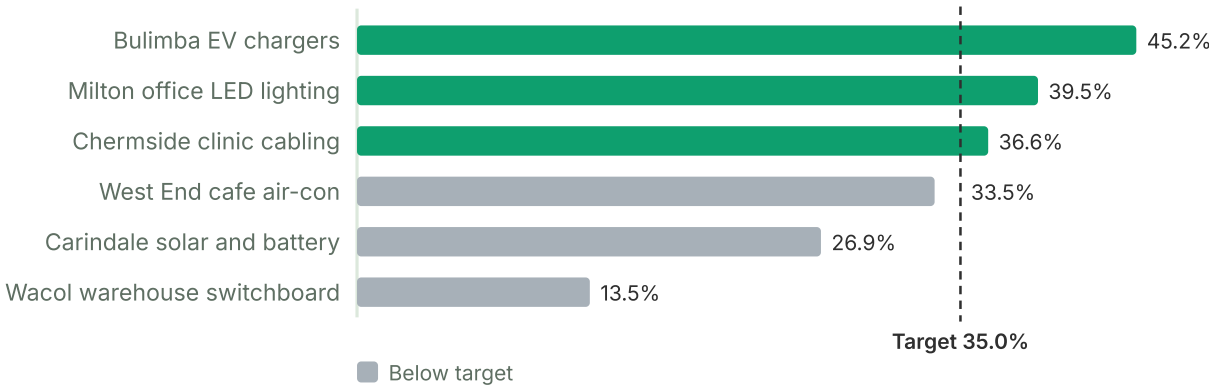
64.3%

▲ from 61.6% in Aug

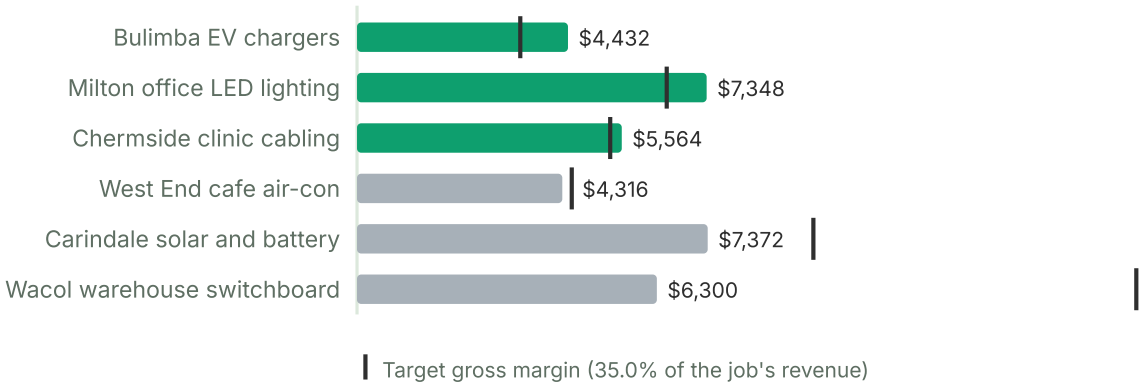
Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in September 2026

Whole job, recognised when invoiced: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68/hour. Before overheads: not profit. One 35.0% target for every job for now.

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



How each number is worked out

Gross margin (P&L)

Gross profit ÷ revenue. All technician wages and on-costs included; overheads are not.

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Revenue (every job invoiced in the month)	\$202,337	\$179,007
Materials	(\$64,860)	(\$51,530)
Subcontractors	(\$13,200)	(\$9,300)
Technician wages	(\$54,600)	(\$54,600)
Gross profit	\$69,677	\$63,577
Gross margin (P&L)	34.4%	35.5%

Gross margin is before overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent and so on): it is not profit. Wages include all on-costs (super, payroll tax, workers' compensation, leave). Technicians are on salary, so a quiet month for jobs lowers gross margin even if every job is priced well.

Cost to win a customer

Marketing spend ÷ new customers

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Marketing spend	\$7,600	\$8,400
New customers (first job ever)	47	41
Cost per new customer	\$162	\$205

Technician time on jobs

Hours charged to jobs ÷ hours available

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Hours charged to jobs (timesheets)	752.5 h	655.0 h
Technicians	7	7
Working days	22	20
Hours per day	7.6 h	7.6 h
Hours available	1,170.4 h	1,064.0 h
Time on jobs	64.3%	61.6%

August had one fewer working day for the Ekka show holiday. The rest is travel, training, quoting and waiting time.

Jobs, September 2026

Job	Type	Revenue	Materials	Subcontractors	Labour cost (incl. on - costs)	Job gross margin	Job gross margin %
Bulimba EV chargers	Installation	9,800	3,600	-	1,768	4,432	45.2
Carindale solar and battery	Installation	27,400	13,800	3,100	3,128	7,372	26.9
Chermside clinic cabling	Installation	15,200	4,300	1,800	3,536	5,564	36.6
Milton office LED lighting	Installation	18,600	6,900	-	4,352	7,348	39.5
Wacol warehouse switchboard	Installation	46,800	22,900	7,400	10,200	6,300	13.5
West End cafe air-con	Installation	12,900	5,100	900	2,584	4,316	33.5
Ashgrove aged care	Maintenance contract	3,600	80	-	1,360	2,160	60.0
Bulimba school	Maintenance contract	2,800	60	-	1,088	1,652	59.0
Carindale vet clinic	Maintenance contract	1,700	30	-	612	1,058	62.2
Chermside retail centre	Maintenance contract	4,100	100	-	1,564	2,436	59.4
Fortitude Valley hotel	Maintenance contract	3,400	70	-	1,292	2,038	59.9
Kangaroo Point townhouses	Maintenance contract	2,400	50	-	952	1,398	58.2
Milton office tower	Maintenance contract	4,200	90	-	1,632	2,478	59.0
Newstead gym	Maintenance contract	1,600	30	-	612	958	59.9
Riverside Apartments (strata)	Maintenance contract	3,200	60	-	1,224	1,916	59.9
Rocklea factory	Maintenance contract	3,900	110	-	1,496	2,294	58.8
Southbank cafe group	Maintenance contract	1,800	40	-	680	1,080	60.0
Wacol logistics depot	Maintenance contract	3,000	70	-	1,156	1,774	59.1
West End brewery	Maintenance contract	2,600	50	-	1,020	1,530	58.8
Wynnum medical centre	Maintenance contract	2,200	40	-	816	1,344	61.1
64 call-outs (each one is in the Excel)	Call-out	31,137	7,380	-	10,098	13,659	43.9

Profit and loss, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Revenue			
Maintenance contracts (14)	40,500	40,500	-
Installations (jobs)	130,700	109,600	21,100
Call-outs and repairs	31,137	28,907	2,230
Total revenue	202,337	179,007	23,330
Cost of sales			
Materials	(64,860)	(51,530)	(13,330)
Subcontractors	(13,200)	(9,300)	(3,900)
Technician wages (incl. on-costs)	(54,600)	(54,600)	-
Total cost of sales	(132,660)	(115,430)	(17,230)
Gross profit	69,677	63,577	6,100
Operating expenses			
Office and admin wages	(21,900)	(21,900)	-
Marketing	(7,600)	(8,400)	800
Vehicles and fuel	(8,300)	(7,900)	(400)
Rent and occupancy	(7,000)	(7,000)	-
Insurance	(3,000)	(3,000)	-
IT and software	(2,300)	(2,300)	-
Other overheads	(3,900)	(3,600)	(300)
Total operating expenses	(54,000)	(54,100)	100
EBITDA	15,677	9,477	6,200
Depreciation	(4,500)	(4,300)	(200)
Interest	(1,080)	(1,100)	20
Profit before tax	10,097	4,077	6,020
Income tax provision (25%)	(2,524)	(1,019)	(1,505)
Net profit after tax	7,573	3,058	4,515

Balance sheet at 30 September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Current assets			
Cash at bank	59,746	65,263	(5,517)
Trade debtors (unpaid invoices)	151,063	129,819	21,244
Materials on hand	66,000	66,000	-
Prepayments	21,000	21,000	-
Total current assets	297,809	282,082	15,727
Vehicles and equipment	255,200	247,700	7,500
Total assets	553,009	529,782	23,227
Current liabilities			
Trade creditors (bills due next month)	78,060	60,830	17,230
Employee leave provisions	106,000	105,100	900
Income tax payable	35,043	32,519	2,524
Total current liabilities	219,103	198,449	20,654
Equipment finance	95,000	100,000	(5,000)
Total liabilities	314,103	298,449	15,654
Net assets	238,906	231,333	7,573
Equity			
Share capital	10,000	10,000	-
Retained earnings	228,906	221,333	7,573
Total equity	238,906	231,333	7,573

Cash flow, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Operating activities			
Receipts from customers (invoices paid)	181,093	156,273	24,820
Payments to suppliers	(92,930)	(97,510)	4,580
Payments to employees	(75,600)	(75,400)	(200)
Interest paid	(1,080)	(1,100)	20
Income tax paid	-	-	-
Net cash from operating activities	11,483	(17,737)	29,220
Investing activities			
Purchase of vehicles and equipment	(12,000)	-	(12,000)
Net cash from investing activities	(12,000)	-	(12,000)
Financing activities			
Equipment finance repaid	(5,000)	(5,000)	-
Net cash from financing activities	(5,000)	(5,000)	-
Net change in cash	(5,517)	(22,737)	17,220
Cash at start of month	65,263	88,000	(22,737)
Cash at end of month	59,746	65,263	(5,517)

Assumptions

The business

What it is	An electrical and air-conditioning contractor in Brisbane: maintenance contracts, installations and call-outs. 7 technicians, 3 office staff.
Reporting month	September 2026 (the last closed month), compared with August 2026
Financial year	FY2027: 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

Jobs (September)

Maintenance contracts	14 customers, invoiced on the 1st, paid in about 30 days
Installations	6 named jobs, each with its own quote, materials, subcontractors and hours
Call-outs	64 jobs at \$145/hour plus materials marked up 30%
Jobs in September	84 in total (every one is in the Excel download and CSV)

Costs

Technicians	7 on salary: \$54,600 a month incl. on-costs
Job costing rate	\$68/hour for technician time charged to a job
Working days	20 in August (Ekka show holiday), 22 in September; 7.6 hours a day
Overheads	set month by month, as shown in the P&L
Income tax	25% of profit, provided monthly; next PAYG instalment due October

Cash and balance sheet

Customer payments	each invoice is paid on its own date; unpaid invoices at month end = debtors
Supplier bills	materials and subcontractors are paid the following month
Equipment finance	\$5,000 repaid each month
New equipment	a \$12,000 trailer bought in September
GST	excluded throughout, for simplicity

Checks (all passed)

- ✓ Every subtotal and total adds up
- ✓ Balance sheet balances: assets = liabilities + equity
- ✓ Cash flow ends at the cash in the bank
- ✓ Profit ties to the movement in retained earnings
- ✓ Every job's revenue, materials and subcontractors add up to the P&L
- ✓ Trade debtors equal the invoices still unpaid at month end

Generated 2026-10-06 by a driver-based model: every figure is calculated from the assumptions above. Sample data only, not financial advice.